# INDIAN CALORIE & WALKING GUIDE

Practical estimates for adults around 5 ft 8 in (173 cm)

**Main idea: calorie needs depend on age, sex, weight, daily movement and exercise. Use these numbers as starting estimates, then adjust using your weight trend over 2–4 weeks.**

## 1. Estimated daily calorie needs

Illustration for a 32-year-old adult male, 173 cm tall. Individual needs may differ, especially with age, body composition, health conditions and activity.

| Weight | BMR / resting | Sedentary maintenance | Lightly active maintenance |
|---|---|---|---|
| 75 kg | ~1,660 kcal | ~1,990 kcal/day | ~2,285 kcal/day |
| 80 kg | ~1,710 kcal | ~2,055 kcal/day | ~2,355 kcal/day |
| 85 kg | ~1,760 kcal | ~2,115 kcal/day | ~2,420 kcal/day |
| 90 kg | ~1,810 kcal | ~2,175 kcal/day | ~2,490 kcal/day |

**BMR** is the energy your body uses at rest for essential functions. **Maintenance calories** are the approximate daily intake at which weight stays stable. “Sedentary” means mostly sitting; “lightly active” includes some exercise or regular walking.

## 2. A starting calorie target for fat loss

A moderate deficit of about 300–500 calories per day is a common starting point. For the lightly active estimates above:

| Weight | Estimated maintenance | Illustrative fat-loss range |
|---|---|---|
| 75 kg | 2,285 kcal/day | 1,785–1,985 kcal/day |
| 80 kg | 2,355 kcal/day | 1,855–2,055 kcal/day |
| 85 kg | 2,420 kcal/day | 1,920–2,120 kcal/day |
| 90 kg | 2,490 kcal/day | 1,990–2,190 kcal/day |

These are not prescriptions. Monitor average body weight over 2–4 weeks and adjust gradually. Avoid aggressive restriction; seek professional advice if you have a medical condition or take medication affecting weight or metabolism.

## 3. How many steps should you take?

For most adults, building a consistent walking habit matters more than reaching a magic number. Increase gradually from your current baseline.

| Daily steps | Approx. distance | Practical interpretation |
|---|---|---|
| 5,000–7,000 | About 3–5 km | A useful starting range if currently inactive. |
| 8,000–10,000 | About 5–7 km | A practical daily goal for general health and weight management. |
| 10,000–12,000 | About 6–8.5 km | A reasonable higher target if recovery, joints and schedule allow. |
| 15,000+ | Often 9 km or more | Usually not necessary for everyone; more is not automatically better. |

## 4. Approximate calories burned while walking

Estimates below are broad ranges for someone weighing roughly 75–90 kg. Actual expenditure depends on pace, stride length, terrain, fitness and whether the figure refers to total or additional calories.

| Steps | Approx. distance | Approx. walking energy |
|---|---|---|
| 5,000 | 3–3.5 km | 120–200 kcal |
| 8,000 | 5–5.5 km | 200–320 kcal |
| 10,000 | 6–7 km | 250–400 kcal |
| 12,000 | 7–8.5 km | 300–480 kcal |

**Important:** Do not automatically eat back all calories reported by a watch or phone. Walking-calorie estimates can be inaccurate, and your total daily energy needs already include normal movement.

## 5. How to make walking effective

• **Be consistent:** aim for a sustainable daily average rather than occasional very long walks.

• **Add purposeful walking:** 30–60 minutes at a pace that raises breathing while still allowing you to speak in sentences, as tolerated.

• **Break up sitting:** short walks after meals or during work breaks can help you move more across the day.

• **Add strength training:** 2–3 sessions a week can help preserve muscle during weight loss.

# 6. Putting calories and steps together

A sustainable fat-loss plan combines a modest calorie deficit, regular movement, sufficient protein, sleep and consistency. Neither calorie counting nor step counting needs to be perfect.

### Example daily routine

| Time / occasion | Practical habit |
|---|---|
| Morning | Walk when convenient; fasted walking is not required. Have a balanced breakfast with a protein source. |
| Meals | Build meals around vegetables, protein foods, and sensible portions of rice, roti or other grains. |
| During the day | Take short movement breaks and spread steps throughout the day. |
| Evening | Complete the remaining comfortable steps. Include resistance exercise on planned training days. |
| Weekly review | Track average weight, energy, hunger and activity. Change calorie intake gradually if needed. |

# 7. Indian diet and triglyceride-conscious habits

**Choose more often:** seasonal vegetables, whole fruit, dal and beans, whole grains in appropriate portions, eggs, lean chicken or fish, plain curd, and measured portions of nuts.

**Limit:** sugary drinks, frequent sweets, large amounts of refined carbohydrates, deep-fried snacks and excess added sugar. Avoid alcohol, especially if triglycerides have been high.

**Keep fats sensible:** nuts and unsaturated oils can be part of a balanced diet, but they are calorie-dense. Portion size still matters.

If you have previously had triglycerides above 500 mg/dL, follow up with your clinician and repeat blood tests as advised. A later normal result does not guarantee that levels will remain normal. Very high triglycerides may require specific medical and dietary management.

# 8. Simple rules to remember

**1.** Start with a realistic calorie target based on your activity, not just your weight.

**2.** Aim for around 8,000–10,000 steps if comfortable; 10,000 is not a magic threshold.

**3.** Use a moderate calorie deficit and review progress over 2–4 weeks.

**4.** Include protein at each main meal and add strength training when possible.

**5.** Adjust for your health, recovery, hunger and clinician's advice.

**Reminder:** This guide provides general educational estimates, not a medical diagnosis or individualized prescription. Calorie needs vary by sex, age, body composition, health and activity. If you experience dizziness, unusual breathlessness or pain while exercising, stop and seek appropriate medical advice.